

Project: Digital Transformation for ABC Company

Discovery Phase Template Example

Project Title: ABC Company Digital Infrastructure Upgrade

Background Information:

Purpose of Discovery: To identify the requirements for upgrading the digital infrastructure to support remote working and improve data security.

Key Stakeholders: CTO, IT Managers, Security Team, HR, and department heads.

Scope of Discovery:

Areas to Explore: Current infrastructure, remote work capabilities, security vulnerabilities, technology trends, and employee needs.

Limitations and Exclusions: Excludes software development for non-essential applications.

Discovery Activities:

Research Methods: Employee surveys, IT security audits, benchmarking against industry standards.

Data Collection Tools: Online survey platforms, security assessment software.

Expected Outcomes:

Reports: Infrastructure assessment report, remote work feasibility study, security audit results.

Decision Points: Decide on the scope of infrastructure upgrades, security enhancements, and remote work capabilities.

Timeline:

Schedule: 3 months for completion of the discovery phase.

Resource Plan:

Budget: \$50,000 for the discovery phase.

Personnel: IT team, external consultants for security assessment.

Risk Management:

Potential Risks: Inadequate stakeholder input, underestimation of security needs.

Mitigation Strategies: Regular stakeholder meetings, hiring of external security experts.

Project Initiation Document (PID) Template Examples

PID 1: Upgrade of Core IT Infrastructure

Project Title: Core IT Infrastructure Upgrade

Project Background:

Business Case: Essential to support increasing demand for remote work and ensure high reliability and performance.

Scope Statement: Upgrade network hardware, servers, and implement cloud storage solutions.

Objectives and Goals:

Specific Objectives: Enhance network capacity, improve server response time, and increase data redundancy.

Project Deliverables:

Key Deliverables: New network routers, upgraded servers, cloud storage integration.

Project Organization:

Team Structure: Project manager, network team, server specialists.

Stakeholder List: IT department, Finance (for budgeting), vendors.

Resource Plan:

Budget: \$300,000.

Resource Allocation: Internal IT team, hardware vendors, cloud service providers.

Timeline:

Milestones: Completion of hardware installation, server migration, cloud setup.

Schedule: 6 months.

Risk Management Plan:

Risks Identified: Hardware supply delays, unexpected downtime during migration.

Responses: Secure hardware early, plan migrations during low-usage times.

Approval:

Sign-off: CTO and Finance Director.

PID 2: Employee Remote Work Enablement

Project Title: Remote Work Enablement

Project Background:

Business Case: To support a flexible work environment and enhance employee satisfaction.

Scope Statement: Provision of remote access software, security updates, and training for employees.

Objectives and Goals:

Specific Objectives: Enable secure remote access for 200 employees, reduce potential security risks.

Project Deliverables:

Key Deliverables: VPN licenses, multi-factor authentication setup, remote working policies.

Project Organization:

Team Structure: Project manager, IT security team, HR for policy development.

Stakeholder List: All department heads, security consultants.

Resource Plan:

Budget: \$150,000.

Resource Allocation: IT security team, HR, software vendors.

Timeline:

Milestones: VPN setup, security training for employees, policy publication.

Schedule: 4 months.

Risk Management Plan:

Risks Identified: Inadequate training, non-compliance with security policies.

Responses: Comprehensive training sessions, regular compliance audits.

Approval:

Sign-off: HR Director, CTO.

These examples illustrate how you can structure your discovery phase and PIDs to address different aspects of a larger project, ensuring that each sub-project is clearly defined and managed.

User

could you expand on

Scope of Discovery:

Areas to Explore: Current infrastructure, remote work capabilities, security vulnerabilities, technology trends, and employee needs.

Limitations and Exclusions: Excludes software development for non-essential applications.

Discovery Activities:

Research Methods: Employee surveys, IT security audits, benchmarking against industry standards.

Data Collection Tools: Online survey platforms, security assessment software.

i dont really get this part in the discovery

ChatGPT

Certainly! Let's delve deeper into the Scope of Discovery and Discovery Activities sections of your template to clarify what they entail and why they're important.

Scope of Discovery

Areas to Explore

This section outlines the key areas that the discovery phase needs to investigate to ensure the project is comprehensive and meets all necessary criteria.

Current Infrastructure: Assess the existing IT setup including hardware, software, network capabilities, and technological frameworks. This helps in understanding what needs to be upgraded or replaced.

Remote Work Capabilities: Evaluate how well the current infrastructure supports remote working. This includes checking the availability and performance of VPNs, cloud services, and communication tools.

Security Vulnerabilities: Identify any existing weaknesses in the IT security setup, such as outdated software, unprotected data storage, or insufficient network security measures.

Technology Trends: Explore new technologies that could enhance the company's IT capabilities. This might involve looking into advancements in cloud computing, artificial intelligence for IT operations, or cybersecurity enhancements.

Employee Needs: Gather input from employees about their experiences and needs related to IT infrastructure, particularly in terms of remote work, technology tools, and security. This helps ensure that the upgrades will effectively support the workforce.

Limitations and Exclusions

Specifies what the discovery will not cover, which helps in focusing resources and time on the most critical aspects.

Excludes Software Development for Non-Essential Applications: The discovery phase won't explore or propose development for software that doesn't directly support the core objectives of the IT upgrade, such as niche department-specific tools or experimental software projects.

Discovery Activities

Research Methods

These are the techniques you will use to gather the necessary information during the discovery phase.

Employee Surveys: Deploy surveys to collect feedback directly from the users of the infrastructure, the employees. This can provide insights into what works, what doesn't, and what is needed in terms of IT support.

IT Security Audits: Conduct thorough reviews of the current security measures to identify vulnerabilities and areas for improvement. This might include penetration testing, compliance checks, and security systems reviews.

Benchmarking Against Industry Standards: Compare the current IT setup against industry benchmarks to determine how the existing infrastructure measures up against similar companies or industry standards. This can help identify areas where the company is lagging and where it is excelling.

Data Collection Tools

Tools that will facilitate the collection and analysis of data during the discovery phase.

Online Survey Platforms: Utilize platforms like SurveyMonkey, Google Forms, or Microsoft Forms to create and distribute surveys efficiently. These platforms can help in quickly gathering and analyzing employee feedback.

Security Assessment Software: Use specialized software tools designed to assess and report on IT security setups. These might include network monitoring tools, vulnerability scanners, and compliance assessment tools.

By expanding these sections in your template, you can provide a clearer roadmap for how to conduct the discovery phase effectively. This thorough approach ensures that all relevant aspects of the IT infrastructure are evaluated, leading to informed decisions in the subsequent project initiation phase.